Unit 4 — Australia Now

Track G+M · Klasse 10 · Niveau G/M

Learning objectives I

- *I can read a short article on contemporary Australian society and identify two cultural anchors.*
- *I can recognise Australian English vocabulary differences.*
- *I can write a 150-word region portrait that goes past surface stereotypes.*

Lead-in I

Maja's older cousin moved to Brisbane two years ago. Her postcards have stopped pretending. They no longer say *the weather is brilliant*. They now say things like *I have learned to wear sunscreen as a religion* and *the heat is not a season here, it is a relative*. Maja keeps the postcards in her desk drawer.

Reading I

Reading — *Brisbane Postcards*
Australia is more urban than its myth. About 86 % of Australians live in cities. Multiculturalism is real and complicated — Brisbane is home to large Vietnamese and Lebanese communities, and First Nations languages are taught in some primary schools. The bushfire season has lengthened over the past two decades. Sunscreen is not a luxury; it is a habit closer to brushing teeth.

Vocabulary — Australian English
BrE / AmE → AusE often: arvo (afternoon), brekkie (breakfast), barbie (BBQ), servo (petrol station), bushie (bush dweller), maccas (McDonald's), ute (pickup truck), arvo tea (afternoon snack).
Common terms: *fair dinkum* (genuine), *no worries* (it's fine), *mate* (friend, but watch tone).

Practise I

Niveau G

1. Match AusE → standard: arvo, brekkie, barbie, servo → ?
2. T or F from the reading: 86 % live in cities, Vietnamese community in Brisbane, sunscreen optional.

Niveau M

3. Write 4 sentences about contemporary Australia using 2 AusE words and 2 facts from the text.

Your turn I

Region portrait, 150 words. Write about contemporary Australia going past stereotypes. Use 1 AusE word + 2 specific facts.

Sample

Australia is much more urban than its myth. About 86 % of Australians live in cities, and Brisbane — where my cousin lives — is home to large Vietnamese and Lebanese communities, plus a growing First Nations language presence in some primary schools. The bushfire season has lengthened over the past two decades. Sunscreen is not a holiday luxury but a daily habit, closer to brushing teeth than to skincare. People still call afternoon arvo and breakfast *brekkie* — those words are real, not tourist-brochure inventions. What surprised me most, when I read my

Your turn II

cousin’s postcards, was that the heat is described as a relative — annoying, present, sometimes funny, never going away.

Reflect I

- I can identify two cultural anchors in a contemporary Australian article.
- I can recognise 5 AusE words.
- I can write a 150-word region portrait past stereotypes.

Further reading / listening I

- ABC Australia — short news articles.
- Australian Bureau of Statistics — accessible factsheets.